

September 4, 2026 · Reach out to us at Editor@TheMiddleburgPage.com

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SPONSORED SERIES · MARS PETCARE FUNDS THIS PAGE AND REVIEWS ONLY ITS OWN COMPANY CONTENT · THE MIDDLEBURG PAGE RETAINS FULL EDITORIAL CONTROL OF ALL RESCUE REPORTING

Blind Husky gets rescued; Goes home to Husky, 5 cats

By Dana Priest

Pulitzer Prize winner · Piedmont Journalism Foundation board

MIDDLEBURG HUMANE FOUNDATION

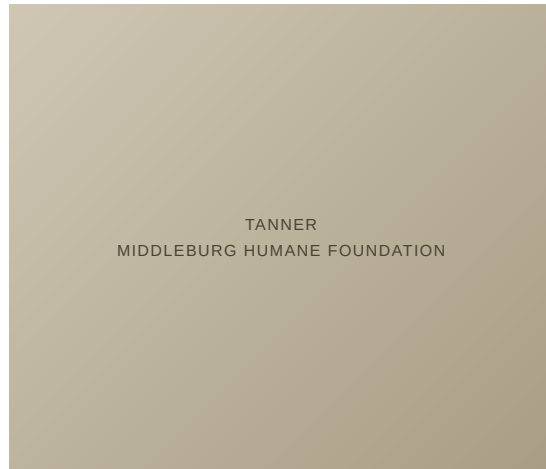
The thing about a blind dog is that he does not know he is a blind dog. He knows the shape of a room, the sound of a bowl, the particular tread of the person coming to get him.

Tanner learned all three in the eleven weeks he spent at the Middleburg Humane Foundation, and then he learned a new set, in a new house, with a sighted husky to follow and five cats to negotiate.

[Dana Priest's reported story — 300 words — drops into this space. Everything around it is final.]

He arrived on a Tuesday in a crate that was slightly too small, from a county two hours south, with a note attached that said only his approximate age and the word "gentle." The note was correct on both counts.

What the note did not say, because nobody knew it yet, was how he would handle a house. Blind dogs map rooms the way the rest of us map a dark hallway at night, by memory and by



My name is "Tanner". Take me home!

touch and by an accumulating confidence that the furniture has not moved since yesterday.

The cats, for their part, worked it out in under a week — which is roughly six days longer than they would like it recorded.

Read the full story and see who else is waiting



SPACE RESERVED — DANA PRIEST, 300 WORDS

"Mars Is Closer Than You Think" Ad Campaign Launched Here

By Leland Schwartz

Editor, The Middleburg Page

When we heard that the candy and pet food company — which makes Milky Ways and Mars bars for us, IAMS and Pedigree for our dogs and Temptations for our cats — wanted to make everyone aware of how local it was, we thought ‘what better way than through the local press?’

And besides, not only is Mars HQ in McLean, but Jacquie Mars lives out here.

So we asked the company — yes, with a little help from our friends — if it would run a year-long test to see if us local news editors could share their message wide enough throughout Hunt Country to be a serious complement to their own social media efforts.

Can local news organizations help drive national brands and recapture a piece of what kept community newspapers alive for decades? That is the question. If this is the first you've heard of the Mars ***"Closer Than You Think"*** campaign, then we're onto something.

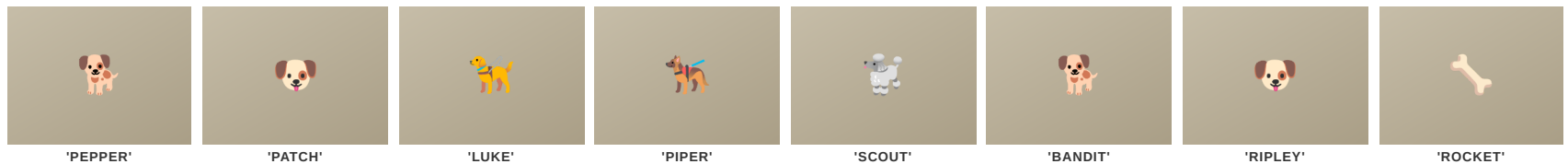
What we're thinking is to bring you two sets of stories over the year juxtaposed to Mars' own messages. The first about rescues; how they work and how you can help, through our colleagues at the Middleburg Humane Foundation. The second describing how Mars is a thought leader in responsible pet ownership and animal adoption as well as how it makes its petfood and the science behind it.

This first story about Tanner was written by Washington Post Pulitzer Prize winner Dana Priest, who is on the board of the Piedmont Journalism Foundation, publisher of the Fauquier Times. (If we do a good job, maybe Mars will include the series in the pet food bags!) The stories on these pages will also go up on the Georgetowner's 'In Country' section.

Read more here



EDITOR'S NOTE: *These dogs each chipped in \$375 to help cover adoption costs and the costs of distributing this page, supplementing support from Mars. Have your dogs help our dogs!*



Mars Invests in American Made Products and Communities

MARS IS CLOSER THAN YOU THINK

SOURCING · AMERICAN AGRICULTURE

MANUFACTURING · 38 US FACTORIES

PET NUTRITION · IAMS · PEDIGREE